

PHISHING AWARENESS

2025 EDITION

Navigating the digital minefield of social engineering, AI-driven scams, and the rising threat of "Quishing."

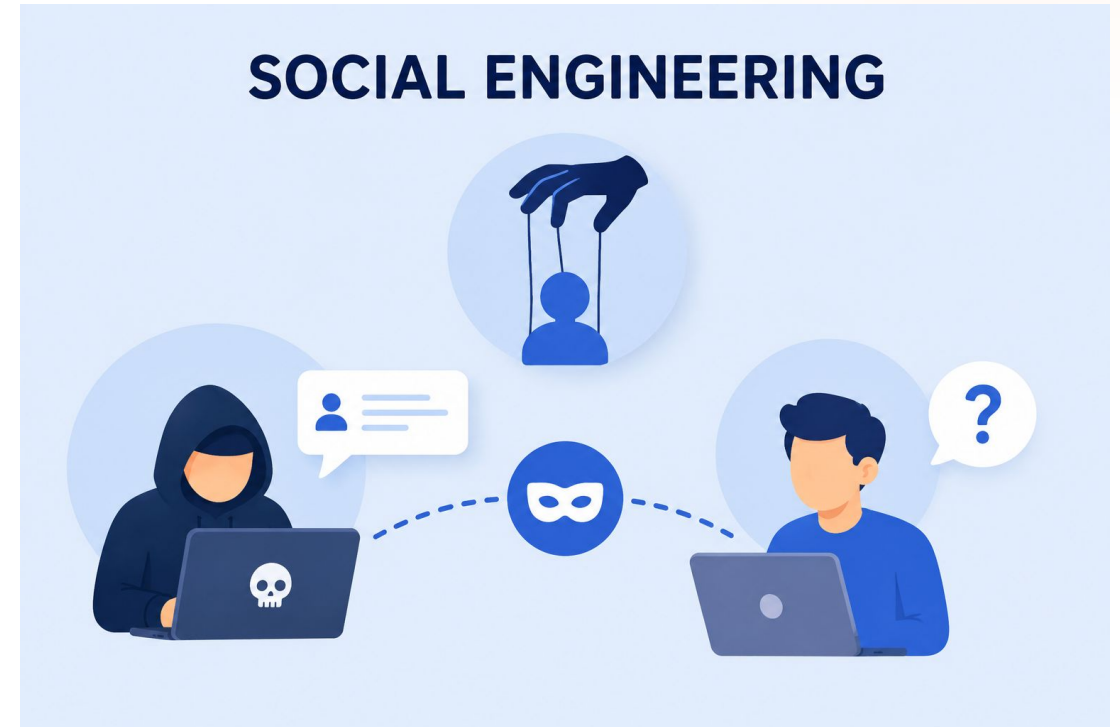
STAY VIGILANT. STAY SECURE.

| WHAT IS PHISHING?

Social Engineering at Scale

Phishing is a fraudulent attempt to obtain sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, and credit card details by disguising oneself as a trustworthy entity in electronic communication.

In 2025, phishing has evolved beyond simple emails, utilizing AI to create perfect imitations of corporate voices and visual branding.



| PHISHING TRENDS: Q1 2025



Phishing volume reached its highest quarterly total in history in 2025, driven by 3.4 billion emails sent daily.

| COMMON VECTORS OF ATTACK



Bulk Email

Generic mass-mailings designed to hit thousands of inboxes simultaneously, hoping for a 1-3% click rate.



Smishing

SMS-based phishing that targets mobile users with fake shipping alerts or bank security warnings.



Vishing

Voice-based phishing using VoIP and AI voice-cloning to impersonate technical support or IT staff.

| THE "BIG GAME" TARGETS

Spear Phishing vs. Whaling

Spear Phishing: Highly targeted attacks against specific individuals or departments, using researched personal details to build trust.

Whaling: A subset of spear phishing that specifically targets high-value executives (CEO, CFO) to authorize large wire transfers or reveal trade secrets.

THE QUIISHING THREAT

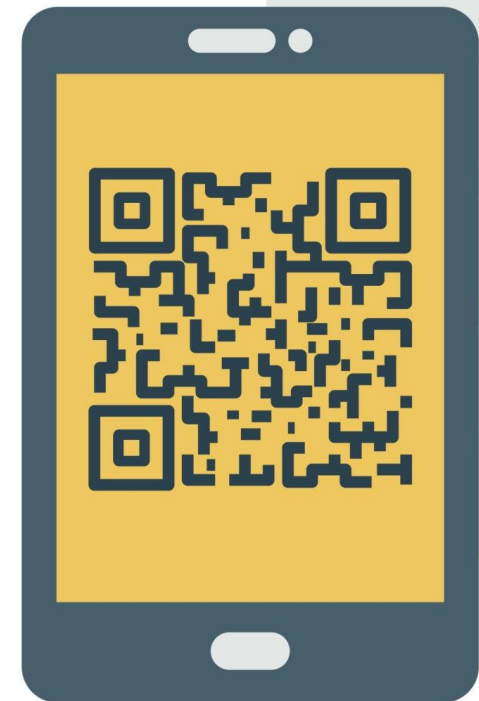
Exploring the dangerous rise of QR Code Phishing

| WHAT IS QUISHING?

Cybercriminals use QR codes to bypass traditional email security filters. Since scanners only see an image, the malicious URL remains hidden.

Common Tactics:

-  Fake restaurant menu codes
-  Emails impersonating trusted contacts, such as HR or colleagues
-  2FA verification email attachments



| SPOTTING THE RED FLAGS



Artificial Urgency: Language like **"Immediate Action Required"** or "Account Suspended in 2 hours."



Suspicious Sender: Mismatched display names and email addresses (e.g., "Microsoft Support" from @gmail.com).

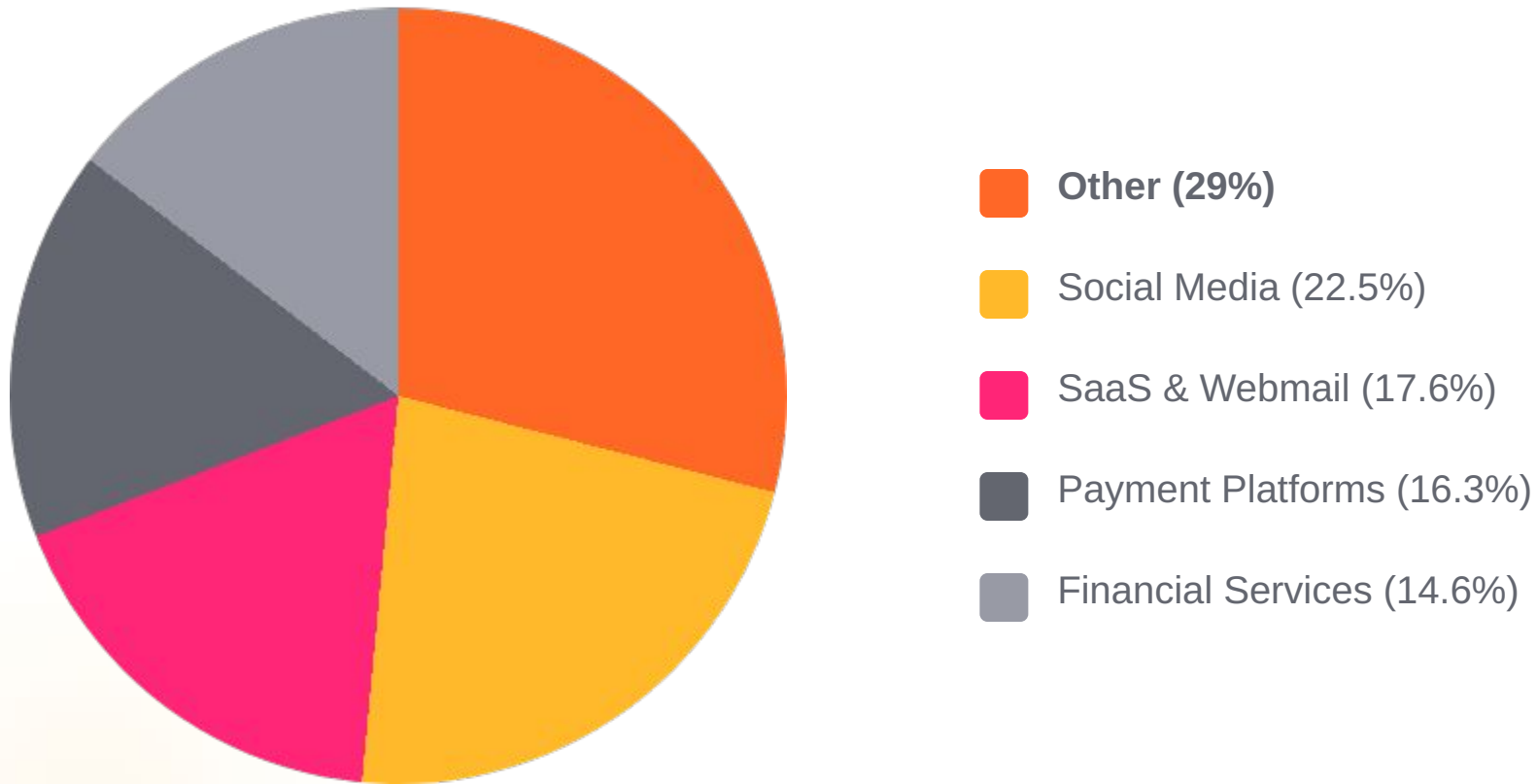


Masked Hyperlinks: Hover your mouse over any link to see the real destination URL in the bottom corner of your screen.

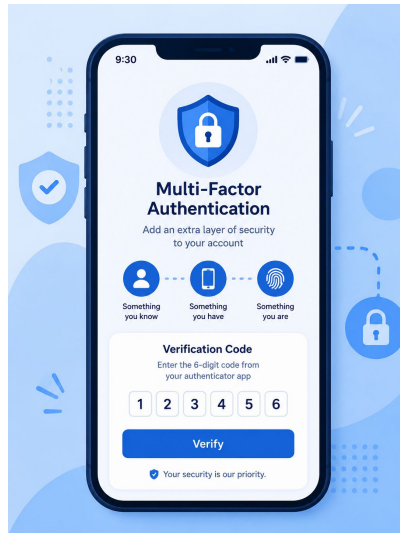


Grammar & Tone: Look for awkward phrasing, spelling mistakes, or generic greetings like "Dear Customer."

| WHO IS BEING TARGETED?



| MULTI-LAYERED DEFENSE



Technology

Implement Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and AI-based email filtering.



Education

Ongoing awareness training and real-world phishing simulations.

| WHAT TO DO IF YOU CLICK?

1. Immediate Action



Disconnect your device from the network immediately. If you entered credentials, change your password from a clean device.

2. Report Incident



Contact the IT Security team via their official phone number or portal. Do not forward the original phishing email.